

Week 5 Activity Log

Introduction to Node.js & Backend Concepts

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Program: CoderAxo Web Development Internship

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Overview

Week 5 shifted from the browser to the server side. Sessions introduced Node.js and the basics of how backend applications work, laying the groundwork for the MERN stack topics coming up in the following weeks.

Activities Completed

- Live session on what Node.js is and how it lets JavaScript run outside the browser
- Set up Node.js locally and got familiar with npm – installing packages, package.json, and dependency management
- Learned Node's core modules (fs, path, http) and wrote small scripts using them
- Built a very basic HTTP server from scratch using the built-in http module to understand requests and responses before moving to frameworks
- Introduced to Express.js basics – routes, middleware, and request/response handling
- Practiced creating simple GET/POST routes and returning JSON responses
- Learned the general idea of REST APIs and how the frontend and backend communicate

Key Learnings

- How the request-response cycle works on the server side
- The role of npm and package.json in managing a Node project
- Why Express simplifies routing compared to plain Node http

Notes

Coming from mostly frontend work, thinking in terms of routes and requests took a bit of adjustment, but the basic HTTP server exercise made the concept click before jumping into Express.